

JOURNAL EDITOR'S WELCOME

Welcome to the re-emergence of *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate: The Journal of the Cross-Examination Debate Association*. The intercollegiate debate community is a brilliant locus for new ideas, discussion, and scholarship. My hope is that *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate* can serve as forum to bring the intellectual fire that powers our debates to the wider scholarly community. Our goal is to be the home of high-quality research in, on, or around the activity of debate as competitive activity and the public sphere. The scholarship of our community—and the scholarship of anyone interested in studying debate—deserves a specific platform to be seen, evaluated, and challenged. This is that platform.

This volume of *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*—volume 38—represents the first publication of the journal after a six-year hiatus. In a wonderful symmetry, the last volume of *CAD* to be published in 2017 honored the legacy of Alfred “Tuna” Snider. This volume, a special edition edited by Shanara Reid-Brinkley and Shauntrice Martin, honors the legacy of the Louisville Project in debate. The closing and opening of two different eras of the journal serve to show that what happens in our community resonates beyond our community. Our scholars and leaders influence the intellectual climate of the academy and society far beyond the limits of our competitions. A scholarly journal is not the only way to influence the attitudes, beliefs and actions of faculty, students, or the public, but it is an important one. The rigor of a peer-reviewed journal shows that we are community with deep intellectual roots, willing to submit our ideas to challenge, revision, and scrutiny. As you read this special issue, I think you will agree that our community has much to contribute.

-Michael Souders, Editor